

Hello.

I'm delighted to share my experience and point of view with you. Let me start by sharing how we align.



CAROL BALES

USER RESEARCH

Alignment with Figma



Conduct and deliver high quality research

Quality is a hallmark of my 15+ years as a UX professional. While at THE WEATHER COMPANY, we executed qualitative and quantitative audience research and usability testing. Our findings were instrumental to continued delivery of features and services, grounded in trustworthy research findings.

Aligning with the ELT and stakeholders

At TWC I garnered company-wide recognition as a trusted partner to stakeholders and leadership.

Experienced manager and team leader

Having managed a team of researchers, I have experience training, coaching, fostering collaboration and excellence, career development, and standards and practices.

Experience with product organizations and consultancies

With over 15 years experience as a UX professional, I know how to execute the right research for the need at hand. I am adept at multiple research methodologies and fluent in design and development methodologies.

Highly effective, succinct communicator

At The Weather Company and elsewhere, I introduced more effective ways of planning research and communicating research findings to the stakeholder teams to 'lift all boats' and make the organization more effective at leveraging user research.

Highly Innovative Problem Solver

I'm extremely comfortable in an experimental setting, using rapid problem-solving and iterative prototyping and evaluation to arrive at valid, novel solutions while never losing sight of the needs of the end user.

Career Highlight: The Weather Company



At **The Weather Company**, I achieved widely-recognized impact on the organization by strengthening the research practice, evangelizing human-centered design practices, and continuously executing high-quality, impactful research.

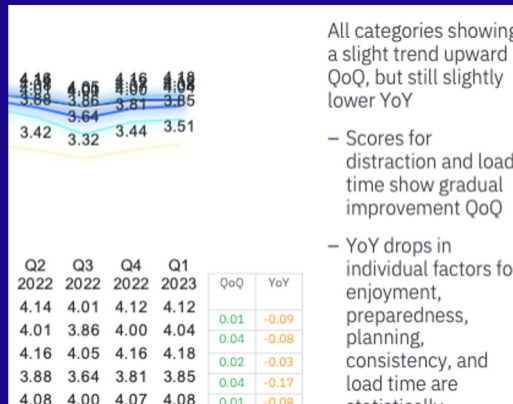
Design validation for novel features.

I executed research to evaluate multiple concepts with content from experts presented in various forms. The winner was developed and released.



Benchmarking customer sat.

I evangelized research from multiple listening channels, creating a research repository, hosting a monthly research showcase, and introducing a quarterly UX benchmark for success metrics.

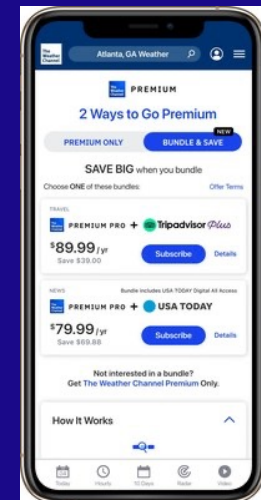


All categories showing a slight trend upward QoQ, but still slightly lower YoY

- Scores for distraction and load time show gradual improvement QoQ
- YoY drops in individual factors for enjoyment, preparedness, planning, consistency, and load time are statistically

Improving purchase process.

Used the RITE method of usability testing to refine a new purchase experience for bundled subscriptions. The results eliminated unforeseen, confusing blockers to the purchase process.



Even More Career Highlights

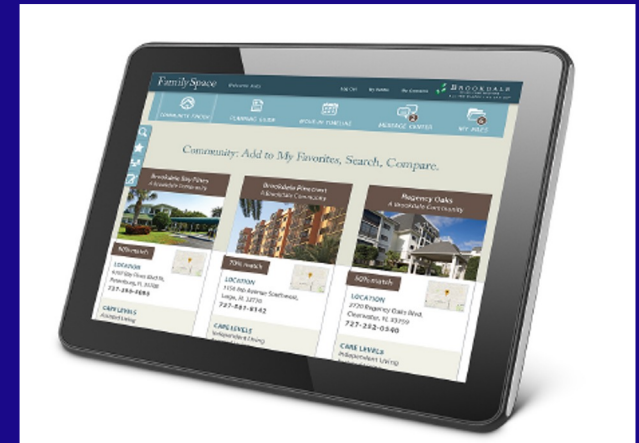


#1 At Brookdale Senior Living, I **prototyped a decision-support tool** to optimize the community selection and move-in processes. I then ran research to validate that the business target of reducing attrition during the sales process was achievable. Brookdale Senior Living (by StellarX)

#2 At Delta Airlines, I ran observational user research with call-center representatives, then with the learnings, prototyped an optimized call-center application to **reduce call-wait and call-processing times**.

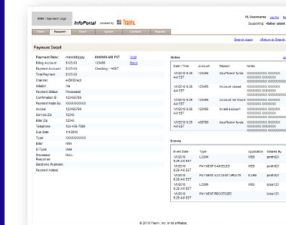
#3 As lead UX and researcher at Fiserv, I **improved the findability of key information by 70%** in their bill-pay call-center application, and triaged issues with the search API for Walmart Money Centers bill payment system.

#4 Through extensive A/B split-testing, I **optimized the hotel search and booking process**, resulting in significant increases in revenue for InterContinental Hotels Group.



Participants were shown 3 views of a payment detail

2. Navigate to a separate page



Several participants initially preferred this view to #1 for clarity and lack of busy-ness.

When prompted to consider that the advantages / disadvantages of navigating away from the search results, participants then preferred either #1 or #3

Some of the brands who've trusted me to impact strategy and improve experiences...





Guiding Principles

- | | | |
|---|--|---|
| 1 | Understand the business and user needs | <i>If they aren't well understood, facilitate better definition before designing the research</i> |
| 2 | Set stakeholder expectations early and often | |
| 3 | Don't overdesign the research | <i>Right-sized research is more efficient and more successful</i> |
| 4 | Facilitate excellence at every stage | <i>Treat (almost) every project, every interaction as an opportunity to learn and inform</i> |
| 5 | Tailor the the output to the audience | <i>Findings should be clear and actionable</i> |
| 6 | Follow through | <i>Stay engaged to protect the authenticity of the project</i> |
| 7 | Celebrate the wins | <i>Morale is important</i> |



Thank you.

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